TOUCH ENGLISH™
SPEAK WITH CONFIDENCE

STUDENT WORKBOOK · LEVEL 2

Suggest What Someone Should Do About a Problem

Recommend | OREO | Client Role-play

Name: _____ Date: _____

SLIDE 02 Today's goal

By the end of this lesson, I can:

Find out what someone needs, suggest what they should do with a reason and a comparison, and answer their worry or change your suggestion.

WHO Mei Ling has been our accounts assistant for five years. At lunch she tells you and Siti: 'I want to move to sales, but I'm scared. What should I do?'

SITUATION She is bored with invoices and wants to work with customers, and Kumar needs one more person in sales. Mei Ling earns RM3,200 a month now. The two ideas are in the boxes below.

NEED She pays RM900 a month for her house loan, so she needs a steady income. She is also afraid she won't be good at selling.

GOAL Suggest what she should do, say why it fits her needs, compare it with the other idea, and answer her worry, or change your suggestion.

Idea 1: Move to sales now

- Basic pay RM2,500 a month (RM700 less than now)
- Plus commission: from RM0 to about RM1,500 a month
- Kumar can start training her next month

Idea 2: Try sales first

- Stay in accounts on RM3,200 a month
- Go with Kumar on 2 customer visits a month for 3 months
- Mr. Tan must say yes to the visits

SLIDE 03 Try it first

Mei Ling asks: “I want to move to sales, but I’m scared. What do you think I should do?” Say something for 30 seconds. Then note what you said.

SLIDE 04 A good message

Siti’s answer. Mark where each part starts.

You need a steady income for your house, so I think you should try sales first, before you move. The main reason is money. In sales the basic pay is RM2,500, RM700 less than now, and commission can be zero in a slow month. Your house loan is RM900 a month. I know you’re afraid you won’t be good at selling, so trying first is safer than moving now. For example, go with Kumar on two customer visits a month. So overall, try it for three months. If you still enjoy it, then ask Mr. Tan to move you to sales.

O NEED · SUGGESTION

R REASON

E WORRY · COMPARE

O SUGGESTION AGAIN

SLIDE 05 Organise it

Ali advises a friend whose new manager shouts at her in meetings. Order: Suggest → Reason → Compare → Suggest again.

- [ ] Quitting is easier than a hard talk, but you'll lose a good job. My old boss changed after one talk.
- [ ] So talk to her this week. If nothing changes in a month, then start looking.
- [ ] You like the job and the pay, so I think you should talk to your manager before you quit.
- [ ] The main reason is that a new job can take months to find, and you still like the work itself.

Write the letter: **O** = Need · suggestion · **R** = Reason · **E** = Worry · compare · **O** = Suggestion again

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SLIDE 06 Useful language

Tick the expressions you used today.

ASK ABOUT THE PROBLEM

- [ ] What's the problem, exactly?
- [ ] What matters most to you?
- [ ] What are you worried about?

SUGGEST

- [ ] You need …, so I think you should …
- [ ] I'd suggest …
- [ ] Why don't you …?
- [ ] It may be better to …

REASON AND COMPARE

- [ ] The main reason is …
- [ ] … is safer / quicker than …
- [ ] … is easier, but …
- [ ] That way, you can …

ADD A CONDITION

- [ ] If you …, you'll …
- [ ] If that doesn't work, then …
- [ ] Try it for … first. If …, …

ACKNOWLEDGE AND RESPOND

- [ ] I understand you're worried, but …
- [ ] That's a fair point. Then you could …
- [ ] You're right. In that case, …

SLIDE 07 Connect the ideas

Choose the connector and write the new sentence.

1. You need a steady income. [for example, / because / so] I think you should try sales first.

2. Moving now is quicker. [but / so / because] Trying first is safer.

3. I'd suggest trying first. [but / because / or] You keep your RM3,200 while you try.

4. You still enjoy it after three months. [because / For example, / If …] Ask Mr. Tan to move you to sales.

SLIDE 08 Time control

Circle the right form. Why?

1. In sales, the basic pay _____ RM2,500 a month. (A fact now)
   ○ being ○ is ○ be

2. I think you _____ try sales first. (Advice)
   ○ should ○ should to ○ shoulds

3. If you move now, your pay _____ by RM700. (What will happen)
   ○ will drop ○ will dropping ○ will drops

4. If you still _____ it after three months, ask Mr. Tan. (The if part)
   ○ enjoying ○ enjoy ○ to enjoy

SLIDE 09

should · could · safer than · if … will

To give advice, say what the person should or could do, compare it with the other idea, and add a condition with if.

I think you **should** try sales first.

You **could** go with Kumar on two customer visits a month.

Trying first is **safer than** moving now, but moving now is **quicker**.

If you move now, your pay **will** drop by RM700.

SLIDE 10

Build your message

Fill each part with your own idea. You will use the same parts in the task.

O

NEED · SUGGESTION

You need …, so I think you should …

R

REASON

The main reason is …

E

WORRY · COMPARE

I know you're worried about …, but … is safer / quicker than …

O

SUGGESTION AGAIN

So overall, … If …, then …

SLIDE 11

Client Role-play

The adviser asks about the problem, suggests one of two ideas and answers the person's worry. The person with the problem writes a note: what to do, why and the other idea, and whether the worry was heard and answered.

1. Round 1 (3:00): say your card number. Ask about the problem and what matters. Suggest one idea, say why, compare.
2. Listener: fill the note, read it back, then say your worry (not before). Adviser: 'I understand …', answer or change.
3. Round 2 (2:00): line B moves. Same card, new listener: ask, one idea, one reason, then hear and answer the worry.
4. Round 3 (1:00), frames closed: card only, no worry. Listener fills lines 2–3. Then swap roles: rounds 1–3 again.

Card 1 · A customer who messages at night

Card 2 · Selling kuih at the weekend

Card 3 · A cousin who keeps borrowing

Card 4 · A talk at the monthly meeting

Listener's note

	ROUND 1	ROUND 2	ROUND 3
Card · asked first?			
What I should do			
Why · the other idea			
Worry: heard · answered?			

My partner's question or concern, and what I answered:

SLIDE 12 Respond

Mei Ling asks. Write a short answer to one of these.

1. But what if Mr. Tan says no?
2. My house loan is RM900 a month. Is sales really safe for me?
3. What if I try it and I don't like it?

Start with: **I understand you're worried, but … · That's a fair point. Then you could … · You're right. In that case, I'd suggest … instead.**

SLIDE 13 Transfer

A friend wants to move out of her parents' house into a rented room near her work; today she spends two hours a day on the bus. The room is RM600 a month and she earns RM2,800. Two ideas: move now, or save RM3,000 first and move in six months. She is afraid her parents will be upset. Suggest what she should do, then answer her worry.

You need …, so I think you should … · The main reason is … · … is safer than …, but … · I understand you're worried, but …

SLIDE 14 Did I do it?

Be honest. Tick what you did in the task.

- [ ] Names what the person needs and suggests one thing to do.
- [ ] Gives a reason and compares the idea with the other one.
- [ ] Acknowledges a worry, then answers it or changes the suggestion.

SLIDE 15

Feedback: how can I improve?

Circle one number for each area. 1 = I need help · 2 = OK · 3 = Good

Need and suggestion	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Reason and comparison	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Answering a worry	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Useful expressions	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Confidence	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3

My improvement action: Next time, I will _____.

WE BELIEVE IN THE POWER OF PRACTICAL SPEAKING TO INSPIRE CONFIDENCE

After class: open the After class review

SLIDE 11

Listener cards: fold or cut

Only the listener looks at a card. It says what to find out and write in the note.

Card 1 · A customer who messages at night

You are Kumar. A big customer sends you WhatsApp messages until 11 p.m. and wants fast replies. You want your evenings with your two children. Your worry: 'What if he buys from another company?'

Card 2 · Selling kuih at the weekend

You are Siti. Your family loves your nyonya kuih. You want to earn some extra money, but you work all week and you don't want to waste money. Your worry: 'What if nobody buys?'

Card 3 · A cousin who keeps borrowing

You are Ali. Your cousin has borrowed RM300 from you three times this year and paid back only once. You are saving to buy a car in June. Your worry: 'My mother will be upset if I say no.'

Card 4 · A talk at the monthly meeting

You are Ali. In two weeks you must show the new order system to 20 staff at the monthly meeting, in English, up to 15 minutes. You're nervous. Your worry: 'What if they ask something I can't answer?'

SLIDE 11

Speaker cards: fold or cut

Only the speaker looks at a card. The listener keeps this page folded.

Card 1 · A customer who messages at night

Two ideas. 1) Tell him your hours politely: 'I reply from 9 to 6.' Most customers accept it. 2) Ask Mr. Tan for a work phone that you switch off at 6. It costs the company about RM40 a month.

Card 2 · Selling kuih at the weekend

Two ideas. 1) Sell to friends first: post photos on WhatsApp and take orders for Saturday. It costs nothing. 2) Rent a table at the Sunday night market: RM50 a night, lots of buyers, but you need about 200 pieces.

Card 3 · A cousin who keeps borrowing

Two ideas. 1) Say no politely: 'Sorry, I'm saving for something big this year.' 2) Lend a smaller amount one more time, and write down the amount and the date he will pay it back.

Card 4 · A talk at the monthly meeting

Two ideas. 1) Practise the talk three times with a colleague before the day. 2) Show the system on the screen and talk for only 5 minutes, then answer questions later by email.